CP(M) 2026 Invigilated MiniZinc Assessment: band criteria

The Invigilated MiniZinc Assessment on Wednesday 11 November 2026 is worth 30% of the course grade and is band marked: you will receive a band, not a numerical mark. Each question is given a band using the criteria below, and the overall band is the combination of these, weighted by the indicative weights in the question headings.

The assessment asks about the two sample models included in this pack. We are looking for evidence that you understand how each model represents graph burning, that you can reason about the effect of modelling choices, and that you can write and modify MiniZinc models.

When marking, we will consider the following:

- Are your explanations correct, and do they refer to specific variables, constraints and line numbers of the models?
- Are your arguments complete? Where a question asks you to justify an answer or sketch a proof, does your answer say why, and not only what?
- Where you give an example, does it illustrate the point, and have you checked it against the model?
- Where you write MiniZinc, does it express the intended change? Small syntax errors will not be penalised.
- Is the answer concise, including the relevant points? If you are unsure, you may conjecture, as long as you make clear that you are doing so.

The bands are as follows.

- **A.** Every question is answered correctly and completely. Arguments are precise and complete, and refer to the relevant parts of the models. Modified models are correct. The answers show a clear understanding of why the modelling choices in the two models matter, beyond what is needed to describe them.
- **B.** All questions are substantially correct, with gaps in at most a few justifications, or one part missing or weak.
- **C.** The meaning of the variables and of most constraints is explained correctly, and the more routine parts are correct, but arguments about the consequences of modelling choices are incomplete or partly wrong.
- **D.** The main variables and constraints are explained, but several parts contain errors, or modified models do not express the intended change.
- **E.** Some relevant understanding is shown, but the answers have major errors or omissions.
- **F to H.** Little or no evidence of understanding how either model represents a burning sequence.